

BODY SHAPES

Invertebrate body shapes fall into three main categories based on symmetry.



Bilateral symmetry
Many insects, from ladybugs to butterflies, have two halves that mirror each other.



Radial symmetry
Invertebrates such as starfish have several lines of symmetry around a central point.



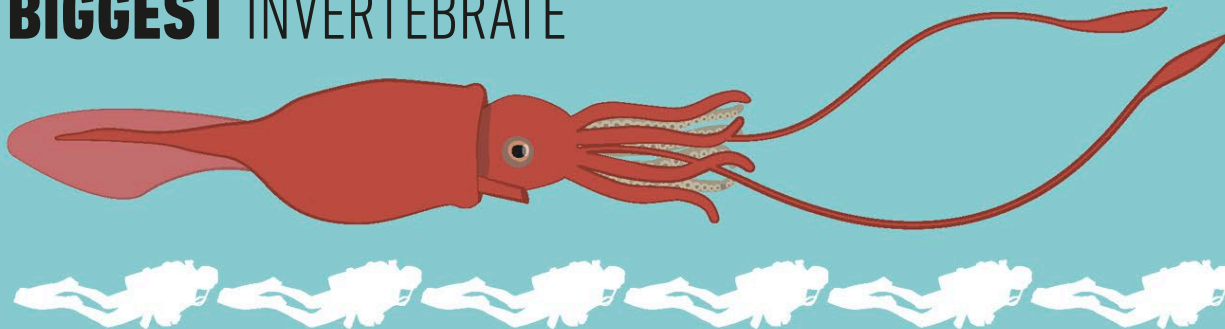
No symmetry
Invertebrates like sponges have no lines of symmetry. They have irregular body shapes.

SMART OCTOPUS

The coconut octopus uses tools, such as discarded coconuts or clam shells, to hide in while watching for prey such as crabs. Living on sandy bottoms in bays or lagoons in the western Pacific Ocean, this clever creature, which extends to about 6 in (15 cm), is also able to pick up and carry these tools more than 66 ft (20 m).



BIGGEST INVERTEBRATE



COLOSSAL SQUIDS LIVE IN THE SOUTHERN OCEAN, AND CAN REACH **411 FT** (12 M) LONG.

SMALLEST INVERTEBRATE



Rotifer



Width of human hair

ROTIFERS ARE AMONG THE WORLD'S SMALLEST ANIMALS AT **0.001 IN** (0.05 MM) LONG.

FASTEST INSECT

The fastest insect relative to its body size is the tiger beetle. This ½ in- (1.4 cm-) long animal covers 120 times its body length in just a single second.



USAIN BOLT OLYMPIC SPRINTER: 5 BODY LENGTHS IN ONE SECOND

TIGER BEETLE: 120 BODY LENGTHS IN ONE SECOND

This long-legged creature runs so fast it temporarily goes blind from the speed.



HIGHEST JUMPER



THE TINY **FROGHOPPER** CAN LEAP MORE THAN **23 IN** (60 CM) IN THE AIR. THAT'S THE EQUIVALENT OF A **HUMAN JUMPING 630 FT** (190 M), OR A **40-STORY BUILDING!**



HIGH LIFE

THE **MOUNT EVEREST JUMPING SPIDER** LIVES UP TO **22,000 FT** (6,700 M) ABOVE SEA LEVEL, ON THE SLOPES OF **MOUNT EVEREST**.

LONGEST MIGRATION

THE **GLOBE SKIMMER DRAGONFLY** MIGRATES **4,400 MILES** (7,080 KM) THROUGH THE AIR **WITHOUT LANDING**.



BIGGEST SWARM

The desert locust gathers in swarms of up to 8 billion. Living in parts of the Middle East, Asia, and Africa, they are known to destroy crops.

